What is Six Sigma and How is it Used in Quality Engineering?

By

Ray Harkins

Another of the most commonly asked questions about quality engineering is "What is Six Sigma and how is it used in quality engineering?"

Six Sigma is a data-driven approach to continuous improvement that aims to reduce defects and variability in products, processes, and systems. It is based on the idea that by identifying and addressing the root causes of defects and variability, organizations can significantly improve the quality of their products and processes. Six Sigma is used to identify and eliminate defects and variability by collecting and analyzing data, identifying patterns and trends, and implementing process improvements.

Six Sigma is often used in quality engineering to identify and address quality issues and improve the overall performance of products, processes, and systems. It involves the use of statistical tools and techniques to identify and analyze quality data, and to identify and implement process improvements. Six Sigma also involves the use of trained professionals, known as Six Sigma "black belts" and "green belts," who are responsible for leading and managing Six Sigma improvement projects.

In brief, Six Sigma is a data-driven approach to continuous improvement that is used to reduce defects and variability in products, processes, and systems. It is often used in quality engineering to identify and address quality issues and improve the overall performance of products, processes, and systems. Six Sigma involves the use of statistical tools and techniques, as well as trained professionals, to identify and implement process improvements.

*Ray Harkins is the General Manager of Lexington Technologies in Lexington, North Carolina. He earned his Master of Science from Rochester Institute of Technology and his Master of Business Administration from Youngstown State University. He also teaches manufacturing and business-related skills such as **Reliability Engineering Statistics**, **Quality Engineering Statistics, Failure Modes and Effects Analysis (FMEA)**, and **Root Cause Analysis and the 8D Corrective Action Process** through the online learning platform, Udemy. He can be reached via LinkedIn at linkedin.com/in/ray-harkins or by email at the.mfg.acad@gmail.com.*